Manual Chapter : Load Balancing to IPv6 Nodes

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Load Balancing to IPv6 Nodes

Overview: Load balancing to iPv6 nodes

To set up the BIG-IP system to function as an IPv4-to-IPv6 gateway, you create a load balancing pool consisting of members that represent IPv6 nodes. You also create a virtual server that load balances traffic to those pool members.

As an option, you can use the tmsh command line interface to configure the BIG-IP system to send out ICMPv6 routing advisory messages, and to respond to ICMPv6 route solicitation messages. When you perform this task, the BIG-IP system begins to support auto-configuration of downstream nodes. Also, the downstream nodes automatically discover that the BIG-IP system is their router.

Task summary for load balancing to IPv6 nodes

When you configure IPv4-to-IPv6 load balancing, you must create a pool for load balancing traffic to IPv6 nodes, and then create an IPv4 virtual server that processes application traffic.

Creating a load balancing pool

The first task in configuring IPv4-to-IPv6 load balancing is to create a pool to load balance connections to IPv6 nodes. Use the Configuration utility to create this pool.

1. On the Main tab, click **Local Traffic › Pools .**
   The Pool List screen opens.
2. Click **Create.**
   The New Pool screen opens.
3. In the **Name** field, type a unique name for the pool.
4. For the **Health Monitors** setting, in the **Available** list, select a monitor type, and click **<<** to move the monitor to the **Active** list.

   Hold the Shift or Ctrl key to select more than one monitor at a time.
5. From the **Load Balancing Method** list, select how the system distributes traffic to members of this pool.

   The default is **Round Robin.**
6. For the **Priority Group Activation** setting, specify how to handle priority groups:
   - Select **Disabled** to disable priority groups. This is the default option.
   - Select **Less than**, and in the **Available Members** field type the minimum number of members that must remain available in each priority group in order for traffic to remain confined to that group.
7. Using the **New Members** setting, add each resource that you want to include in the pool:
   a. (Optional) In the **Node Name** field, type a name for the node portion of the pool member.
   b. In the **Address** field, type an IP address.
   c. In the **Service Port** field, type a port number, or select a service name from the list.
   d. (Optional) In the **Priority** field, type a priority number.
   e. Click **Add.**
8. Click **Finished.**

The load balancing pool appears in the Pools list.

Creating a virtual server for IPv6 nodes

You can define a virtual server that references the pool of IPv6 nodes.

1. On the Main tab, click **Local Traffic › Virtual Servers .**
   The Virtual Server List screen opens.
2. Click **Create.**
   The New Virtual Server screen opens.
3. In the **Name** field, type a unique name for the virtual server.
4. In the **Destination Address/Mask** field, type the IPv6 address in CIDR format.

   The supported format is address/prefix, where the prefix length is in bits. For example, an IPv6 address/prefix is `64:ff9b::/64` or `2001:ed8:77b5:2::/64`.
5. In the **Service Port** field:
   - If you want to specify a single service port or all ports, confirm that the **Port** button is selected, and type or select a service port.
   - If you want to specify multiple ports other than all ports, select the **Port List** button, and confirm that the port list that you previously created appears in the box.
6. In the Resources area of the screen, from the **Default Pool** list, select the name of the pool that contains the IPv6 servers.
7. Click **Finished.**

The virtual server that references the pool of IPv6 nodes appears in the Virtual Servers list.

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